

A SWASHBUCKLING ADVENTURE PANNING DIMENSIONS

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Ratchet and Clank: Rift Apart is a beautiful game giving you the feeling of being in a swashbuckling animated movie. But then again, I said the same thing about Ratchet and Clank: Into the Nexus on the PS3 and the PS4, which was a reimagining of the original Ratchet and Clank. Ratchet and Clank: Rift Apart dials the visuals up to 11 by implementing features like ray-tracing and in HDR the game looks stunning. It is a brilliant adventure, one that fans of the franchise will definitely enjoy. But is it the quintessential Ratchet and Clank experience?

STORY

The story of the game takes place after the Future Saga, which was released for the PS3 and if you haven't played those games, it's OK. While there is a small recap in the form of a celebration at the beginning of the game, it doesn't do justice to the legacy of the franchise. It is also a slight disappointment that one of my favourite characters in the game, Captain Copernicus Leslie Qwark, has a very very small role to play. But that said, the story has a lot of heart and will appeal to newcomers and veter-



ans of the franchise alike. The story is simple, Clank has rebuilt the Dimensionator so that Ratchet, the lone surviving Lombax can find his kin. However, things don't go according to plan and the evil Dr. Nefarious steals the Dimensionator causing massive chaos across the dimensions.

During the chaos, Dr Nefarious opens a rift to an alternate dimension where we are introduced to a female Lombax - Rivet and she is my new favourite Lombax in the franchise. Not only does she have heart, but the voice acting and animation of Rivet is spot on to make you fall in love with the character. She has a metal arm and the history behind her losing her arm is well explored in the story. She also has trust issues and shares the same loneliness of being the only Lombax in her universe - one which we have explored with Ratchet in past

games. She also has some of the best one-liners in the game, which will make you chuckle.

In addition to Rivet, there are callbacks to some beloved characters in the franchise that have a slightly different story in this new dimension. The plot of the game is simple and considering the target audience, rightfully so. It has good lighthearted humour, some interesting plot twists and is definitely a story the family can enjoy together. It has messages like believing in yourself, the virtue of forgiveness, and above all, the power of friendship.

GAMEPLAY

Familiar; yet new, is the best way to describe the gameplay in Ratchet and Clank: Rift Apart. Strafing, jumping, the weapon select wheel and some of the traversing all feel familiar. But